

For example, if you were to purchase electronic equipment, to confirm that what you bought is authentic, all you need to do is use the RFID reader on the phone to take the data from the tag on the hardware. The phone can then send an SMS to the manufacturer, who can confirm whether it is genuine. Also, if the equipment turns out faulty, it becomes easier to lodge a complaint with the manufacturer. Another big plus with RFID-enabled phones is that it is easy to track them down if ever they get lost or stolen.

GPS

The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) of the United States is the body that regulates the manufacture and design of all hardware manufactured or sold in the United States. The FCC recently passed a regulation making GPS mandatory on all cellular phones made and sold in the US. So what is GPS? Global Positioning System or GPS, as the name suggests, is a system that pinpoints your exact location on the globe. It does this by interaction between a series of satellites circumnavigating the earth and base stations at various locations. Used extensively by scientists working in far off locations away from human settlements, and also by people on expeditions, GPS has trickled down from stand-alone readers to wrist watches.



GPS gadgets are essential for scientific expeditions